

Central Scheduling Standard Work: Outpatient Imaging

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Standard work PA-031, version 2.1, effective June 2, 2025. Applies to central schedulers booking outpatient imaging at the Outpatient Pavilion West, Imaging & Therapy Stafford and hospital outpatient imaging. Version 2.1 incorporates lessons from the imaging scheduling consolidation completed in April 2025.

Scope

Covers MRI, CT, ultrasound, mammography, DEXA and X-ray orders for outpatients. Emergency and inpatient imaging is scheduled by the hospital imaging departments.

Outpatient therapy scheduling remains with site front desks until it moves to central scheduling.

Order intake

- 1. Orders arrive through the EHR referral queue, the scheduling fax line or the referral portal.
- 2. The intake scheduler confirms the order is signed, the exam is specific and diagnosis information is present.
- 3. Incomplete orders go back to the ordering office the same day with the missing item named.
- 4. Orders needing prior authorization are routed to the authorization team before scheduling.

Scheduling the exam

- Offer the first available slot at the patient's preferred site, then the other site.
- Book in the EHR enterprise scheduling module; never hold a slot outside the system.
- Contrast exams need the eGFR rule check before booking.
- Book mammography and DEXA together when both are ordered.

Preparation calls

Schedulers call every patient whose exam needs preparation, such as fasting, contrast screening or implant checks for MRI, at least two business days before the exam.

Use the modality prep script in the scheduler reference guide. Document the call outcome in the appointment notes.

Reminders and confirmations

Automated text or voice reminders go out 72 and 24 hours before the appointment. Patients who reply to cancel are offered a new time by the next scheduler on shift, and the slot is released.

Exceptions

- Walk-in patients with orders: site staff call the scheduling lead line; schedulers book the next available slot the same day if possible.
- Urgent orders from physicians: book within two business days or escalate to the imaging lead.
- Interpreter needs: book the interpreter at the time of scheduling.

Measures

Scheduling leads review slots offered, booked and completed and third-next-available appointment for each schedule every Monday, using the weekly access dashboard.